

The list of mining accidents that occurred during the **Monsoon (June–September)** and **Winter (November–February)** seasons, with a specific focus on **iron ore and other mineral mines** (excluding natural flood disasters).

1. Accidents During Monsoon Season

The monsoon season drastically increases the risk of **geotechnical failures** (landslides, wall collapses) and equipment accidents due to slippery conditions and poor visibility.

Iron Ore & Metal Mine Accidents

- **Sindesar Khurd Mine Collapse (Zinc/Lead) – August 2024**
 - **Date:** August 31, 2024 (Monsoon)
 - **Location:** Rajsamand, Rajasthan (Hindustan Zinc)
 - **Incident:** Two workers were buried under debris while operating a jumbo drill machine underground. The debris fall was likely triggered by geological instability exacerbated by local conditions.
- **Joda East Iron Mine Accident – August 2025**
 - **Date:** August 4, 2025 (Monsoon)
 - **Location:** Keonjhar, Odisha (Tata Steel)
 - **Incident:** A worker was fatally crushed between a screen and a discharge chute while clearing a jam. High moisture content in ore during monsoons often leads to sticky material and chute blockages, increasing the need for manual clearing interventions.
- **Bhomman Iron Ore Mine Fatality – August 2026**
 - **Date:** August 2026 (Monsoon)
 - **Incident:** A fatal accident occurred due to the non-functioning of a reverse-warning signal on a wheel loader during heavy rain/wet conditions, which often compromise electrical sensors and visibility.
- **Keonjhar Manganese Mine Collapse – July 2025**
 - **Date:** July 2, 2025 (Monsoon)
 - **Location:** Joda/Barbil Region, Odisha
 - **Incident:** Three people were killed in a landslide/earth collapse during extraction activities. The rain-loosened soil caused the trench walls to cave in.
- **Rajpura Dariba Mine Disaster (Zinc/Lead) – August 1994**
 - **Date:** August 28, 1994 (Monsoon)
 - **Location:** Udaipur, Rajasthan
 - **Incident:** A catastrophic failure of an underground plug caused slurry and water to rush into the lower levels, trapping miners. While involving water, this was a structural failure aggravated by containment issues rather than a natural river flood.

Other Notable Monsoon Accidents

- **Makrana Marble Mine Collapse:** Heavy monsoon rains triggered the collapse of nearly a dozen marble mines in Rajasthan, causing ground cave-ins and road damage.

2. Accidents During Winter Season

Winter accidents are often linked to **structural failures** (rock becomes brittle), **poor visibility (fog)**, and **human factors** (cold stress/fatigue).

Iron Ore & Metal Mine Accidents

- **Dantewada Iron Ore Landslide – February 2024**
 - **Date:** February 27, 2024 (Winter)
 - **Location:** Kirandul, Chhattisgarh (NMDC Project area)
 - **Incident:** A massive rock formation on a hillside collapsed, killing four workers engaged in constructing a retaining wall. This occurred in the dry winter season, highlighting the risk of sudden geological failures independent of rain.
- **Narayanpur Iron Ore Mine Blast – November 2023**
 - **Date:** November 23, 2023 (Winter)
 - **Location:** Narayanpur, Chhattisgarh
 - **Incident:** Two workers were killed when an Improvised Explosive Device (IED) planted near the iron ore site exploded. While conflict-related, this is a significant safety incident affecting mine productivity in the region.

Major Coal/Winter Accidents (Contextual)

- **Lalmatia Mine Collapse – December 2016**
 - **Date:** December 29, 2016 (Peak Winter)
 - **Location:** Godda, Jharkhand
 - **Incident:** A massive slope failure in an open-cast mine killed over 23 workers. Winter fog and temperature drops can affect slope monitoring equipment and visibility.
- **Chasnala Mining Disaster – December 1975**
 - **Date:** December 27, 1975
 - **Incident:** An explosion (likely methane/coal dust) weakened the wall separating the mine from a water-filled abandoned shaft.

3. Incidents Affecting Productivity (Seasonal)

Beyond fatal accidents, these seasonal incidents cause massive **downtime (productivity loss)** in iron ore and mineral belts.

Season	Incident Type	Impact on Productivity
Monsoon	Slope Instability & Pit	Open-cast iron ore mines

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	Stops	(e.g., Odisha, Chhattisgarh) frequently halt stripping and blasting due to unstable slopes and water accumulation, leading to production drops of up to 33% (e.g., Odisha dropped from 20MT to 13MT in 4 months).
Monsoon	Wet Ore Handling (Chute Jamming)	High moisture causes iron ore fines to become sticky, jamming crushers, screens, and chutes. This forces frequent plant shutdowns for manual cleaning (as seen in the Joda East accident) and lowers the Gross Calorific Value (GCV) or quality of the ore.
Monsoon	Logistics & Road Failure	Heavy rains wash out haul roads and damage transport infrastructure. Trucks carrying minerals frequently get stuck or overturn, severing the supply chain from mine to plant.
Winter	Fog & Visibility	Dense winter fog in mining belts (like Jharkhand/Chhattisgarh) reduces the operational hours for dumpers and shovels, leading to shorter shifts and slower cycle times to prevent collisions.

Season	Incident Type	Impact on Productivity
Winter	Cold Stress & Equipment Failure	Extreme cold affects hydraulic systems in heavy machinery (requiring longer warm-ups) and reduces worker dexterity/focus, leading to slower operations and higher error rates.

- [1] <https://www.business-humanrights.org>
- [2] <https://www.scribd.com>
- [3] <https://www.dgms.gov.in>
- [4] <https://www.newindianexpress.com>
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